



Special treatment

Jose Mourinho returned to **haunt** his former club in typical flamboyant fashion.

Joan Mathew Jacob
joan.mathew@thehindu.co.in

Jose Mourinho (**right**) is truly the 'special one', at least in the UEFA Champions League. From leading an unfancied Porto to the title in 2004 to making Inter Milan the only Italian side to win the treble in 2010, the competition is stocked with his iconic moments. He added one more to that list when he led Benfica to a famous 4-2 win over Real Madrid on the final league-phase matchday. Andreas Schjelderup's brace and a Vangelis Pavlidis spot-kick were enough to take all three points.

But with one more goal needed to edge into the playoffs, it was Mourinho who signalled his goalkeeper, Anatoliy Trubin, to join the attack for a late free kick.

In true Mourinho fashion, Trubin ended up heading in the decisive goal (**above**) in the dying seconds, sparking wild celebrations and keeping Benfica alive in the tournament.

The result left Real ninth in the standings, one place off the automatic qualification spots. It will once again face Benfica in the two-legged playoffs. Joining

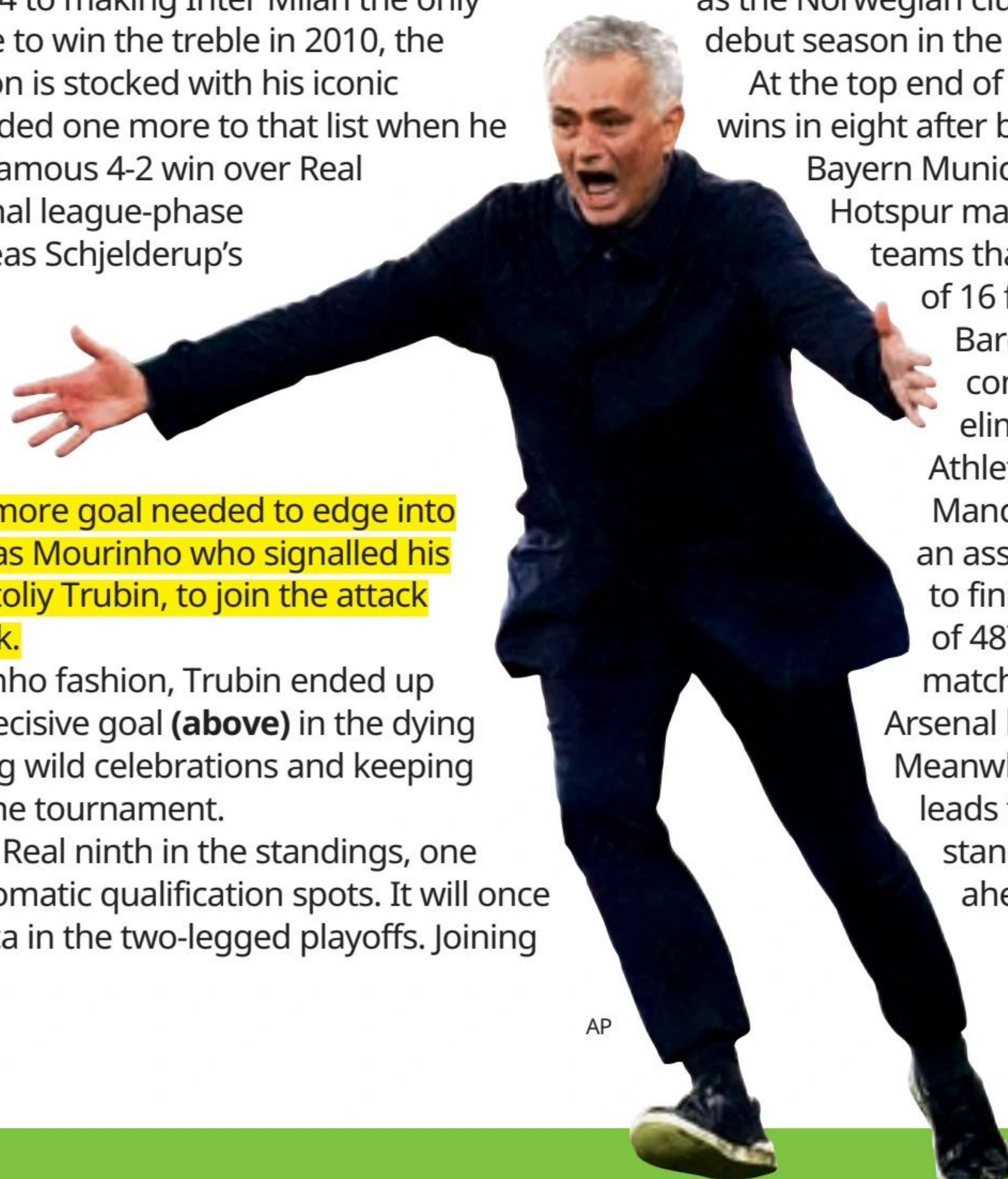
them are defending champion Paris Saint-Germain and Newcastle United, which played out a 1-1 draw, a result that did neither side any favours.

Meanwhile, after shocking Manchester City in the previous gameweek, Bodo/Glimt slayed another giant — Atletico Madrid. Fredrik Sjovold and Kasper Høgh netted as the Norwegian club qualified for the playoffs in its debut season in the competition.

At the top end of the table, Arsenal made it eight wins in eight after beating Kairat Almaty 3-2, while Bayern Munich, Liverpool and Tottenham Hotspur made up the top four. The other four teams that booked their places in the round of 16 finished on 16 points after Barcelona, Chelsea and Sporting completed comeback wins to eliminate Copenhagen, Napoli and Athletic Club, respectively.

Manchester City closed out the list with an assured 2-0 win against Galatasaray to finish one point ahead of Real. A total of 487 goals were scored in 144 matches across the league phase, with Arsenal leading the charts with 23. Meanwhile, Kylian Mbappe comfortably leads the way in the Golden Boot standings with 13 strikes so far, five ahead of Harry Kane in second.

(Results updated as of February 9)



AP